```
      elem.appendChild(div);
    }
  };
  xhr.send();
};

var deletePost = function(postId) {
  var url = 'http://127.0.0.1:9999/api/posts/' + postId;
  var xhr = createXhr('DELETE', url);
  xhr.onload = function() {
    if (xhr.status == 204) {
      var element = document.getElementById('postId' + postId);
      element.parentNode.removeChild(element);
    }
  };
  xhr.send();
};
```

Processes delete request

This listing modifies the client code. Now let's turn our attention to the server code to respond to the `DELETE` request. Listing 4.2 modifies the app.js server code to handle the incoming `DELETE` request. It listens for `DELETE` requests on the /api/posts/{ID} URL. When it receives a `DELETE` request, the code deletes the post with the corresponding ID and returns the HTTP 204 status code. HTTP 204 means that the request was successful, but the body has no content; it's the traditional response code used for `DELETE` requests in REST APIs.

Listing 4.2 Adding server support for deleting posts

```
serverapp.get('/api/posts', function(req, res) {
  res.json(POSTS);
});
serverapp.delete('/api/posts/:id', function(req, res) {
  delete POSTS[req.params.id];
  res.status(204).end();
});
serverapp.listen(SERVER_PORT, function() {
  console.log('Started server at http://localhost:' + SERVER_PORT);
});
```

Listens for delete requests on /api/posts/{ID}

Deletes blog post

Returns HTTP 204

After making the changes in listings 4.1 and 4.2, restart the server and reload the client.html page. You should see a Delete link next to each blog post, as shown in figure 4.6.

The code looks like it should work, because you added CORS support to your server in the previous chapter. But if you click a Delete link, you'll see the error message shown in figure 4.7. What is going on here?

Looking at the error in figure 4.7, one inconsistency should stand out: although the code is making a `DELETE` request ❶, the error is on an `OPTIONS` request ❷. The browser never sends the `DELETE` request. This certainly looks weird, but this isn't a bug. What you're seeing is the preflight request.